

SOP-FALL-900: Fall Protection for Work at Height

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs fall protection requirements for work performed at 6 feet or more above a lower level, including personal fall arrest systems (PFAS), guardrails, and anchor points.

Section 2. Fall Protection Trigger Height

Clause 2.1 — Fall protection (guardrail, PFAS, or safety net) is mandatory at 6 feet for general industry work and 4 feet for work directly over energized equipment or a hazardous process opening, regardless of the general trigger height.

Section 3. Anchor Points

Clause 3.1 — A PFAS anchor point shall be rated for at least 5,000 lbs per attached worker, or engineered with a safety factor of at least 2, and shall never be a handrail, conduit, or unrated structural member.

Section 4. Equipment Inspection

Clause 4.1 — Full-body harnesses and lanyards shall be inspected before each use by the wearer, and formally inspected and tagged by a competent person at least every 6 months.

Clause 4.2 — Any harness or lanyard that has arrested a fall shall be removed from service immediately and destroyed, not reused pending inspection.

Section 5. Rescue Plan

Clause 5.1 — A written rescue plan is required before work begins whenever PFAS is used — suspension trauma after a fall arrest can be fatal within minutes, and self-rescue or assisted rescue must be achievable within 6 minutes of a fall being arrested.

Section 6. Records

Clause 6.1 — Harness/lanyard inspection tags and rescue plans are filed to the Fall Protection File and retained for 3 years.